hire people with the intention of preparing them for larger leadership roles, they look beyond specific skills.

For example, we offer artificial intelligence (AI)-based learning to our students. This is an important skill set that can help managers make better business decisions in a changing environment. But AI itself is not the core objective of management education. It is a capability that can be acquired and applied.

Students who come to institutions like IIM Calcutta are expected to grow into leadership positions in organisations. Therefore, the focus cannot be limited only to current skills. It must also be on the ability to continuously learn and adapt.

Today, it may be AI. Tomorrow, it would be quantum computing, and the day after that would be another emerging technology. The important capability is the ability to understand future changes, anticipate them, and build organisations where people continuously upgrade their skills.

That is what enables effective decision-making and leadership in large organisations.

I do not deny the importance of specific domain knowledge. These skills are important, but changing technologies will continue to influence business.



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Looking ahead five to ten years, what will distinguish an exceptional management education degree?

Institutions like ours receive students who are expected to take up larger leadership roles in organisations, not just immediate job responsibilities.

Therefore, our responsibility is to prepare them for the future rather than only meet the immediate requirements of a job.

While specific skills required for current roles are important, management education must also develop conceptual understanding and decision-making capabilities required for leadership positions.

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What does AI mean for curriculum and pedagogy? How is IIM Calcutta maintaining academic depth while responding to changing industry requirements?

Educational institutions must accept reality and be ready to embrace change. This applies not only to curriculum but also to the way learning is delivered.

At IIM Calcutta, we have introduced AI as part of the curriculum and have undertaken several digital initiatives. We are building AI studios, AI labs and AI-based learning systems.

However, AI is only a tool that we need to embrace. It is not the destination.

Along with technology-focused learning, we are also expanding flexible learning models. We are planning to start an online MBA programme, aligned with the growing importance of hybrid education.